



Raktapitta

Learning Objectives

- ⇒ To learn the concept of Raktapitta
- ⇒ To learn the Nidana Panchaka of Raktapitta explained in Ayurveda literatures
- ⇒ To frame out the probable Samprapti Ghataka based on the progression of the disease
- ⇒ To learn the definition of Raktapitta
- ⇒ To describe the different routes of normal as well as abnormal Rakta Pravritti
- ⇒ To know the Svabhava (nature) of Raktapitta
- ⇒ To enlist the types of Raktapitta
- ⇒ To describe Vishishta Lakshana of Raktapitta
- ⇒ To enlist the Upadrava of Raktapitta
- ⇒ To know the Sadhyasadyata of Raktapitta with current understanding

Introduction

Raktapitta (see Figure 59) is a spectrum of diseases where there is tendency of spontaneous bleeding across natural orifices or through skin. Vitiating of *Pitta Dosha* in relation to *Drava* (liquid) quality will lead to the increase of vitiated blood. This will increase the volume abnormally leading to the expulsion of abnormally vitiated blood through natural orifices and skin.

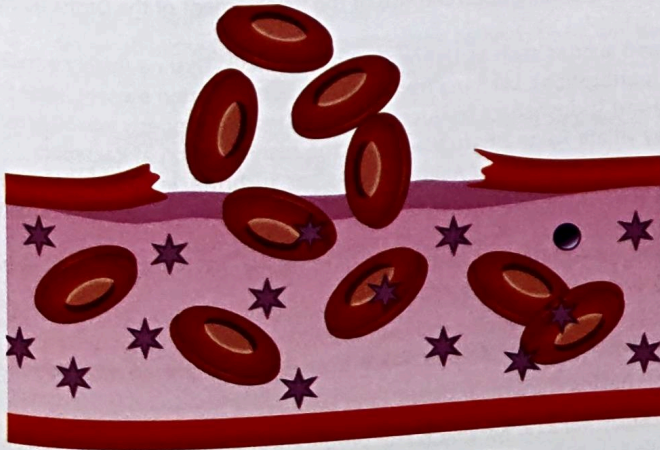


Figure 59: Samprapti of Raktapitta

पित्तं यथाभूतं लोहितपित्तमिति संज्ञां लभते

Ca.Ni. – 2/3

संसर्गाल्लोहितप्रदूषणालोहितगन्धवर्णानुविधानाच्च पित्तं लोहितपित्त-
मित्याचक्षते॥5॥

Ca.Ni. – 2/5

संयोगाद्दूषणात्तत्तु सामान्याङ्गन्धवर्णयोः।

रक्तस्य पित्तमाख्यातं रक्तपित्तं मनीषिभिः॥9॥

Ca.Ci. – 4/9

Abnormal vitiation of *Pitta Dosha* or the vitiated *Pitta* in a particular stage is observed in *Raktapitta*. In this condition, there will be abnormally vitiated *Pitta* which combines with abnormally vitiated *Rakta* combines together leads to the manifestation of *Raktapitta*. In this condition, abnormal *Pitta* as well as *Rakta* will have similar colour, smell.

Nidana of Raktapitta

यदा जन्तुर्यवकोद्दालककोरदूषप्रायाण्यन्नानि भुते, भृशोष्णतीक्ष्णमपि चान्यदन्नजातं निष्पावमा षकुलत्थसूपक्षारोपसंहितं, दधिदधिमण्डोदक्षि-
कराम्ल काञ्जिकोपसेकं वा, वाराहमाहिषाविक मात्स्यगव्यपिशितं,
पिण्याकपिण्डालुशुष्कशाकोपहितं मूलकसर्षपलशुनकर अशिशुमधु-
शिशु (खंड- यूष) भूस्तृणसुमुखसुरसकुठेरकगण्डीरकालमाल
कपर्णा सक्षवकफणिज्झकोपदेशं, सुरासीवीरतुषोद कर्मैरयमेदकमधूल
कशुक्तकुवलबदाम्लप्रायानुपानं वा, पिष्टान्नोत्तरभूयिष्ठम् उष्णाभितप्तो

वाऽतिमा- श्रमतिबेलं वाऽऽमं पयः पिबति, पयसा समश्नाति
 रौहिणीक, काणकपोतं वा सर्षपतैलक्षारसिद्धं, कुलत्थपिण्याकजाम्बवल
 कुचपक्कैः शौक्तिकैर्वा सह क्षीरं पिबेत्पुष्पाभितप्तः तस्यैवमाचरतः
 पित्तं प्रकोपमापद्यते, लोहितं च स्वप्रमाणमतिवर्तते।
 तस्मिन् प्रमाणातिवृत्ते पित्तं प्रकुपितं शरीरमनुसर्पद्यदेव यकृत्प्ली-
 हप्रभवाणां लोहितवहानां च स्रोतसां लोहिताभिष्यन्दगुरुणि
 मुखान्यासाद्य प्रतिक्रियात् तेदेव लोहितं दूषयति॥4॥ Ca.Ni. - 2/4
 क्रोधशोकभयायासविरुद्धान्नातपानलान्।
 कवम्ललवणक्षार तीक्ष्णोष्णातिविदाहिनः॥3॥
 नित्यमभ्यसतो दुष्टो रसः पित्तं प्रकोपयेत्।
 विदग्धं स्वगुणैः पित्तं विहत्वाशु शोणितम्॥4॥
 ततः प्रवर्तते रक्तमूर्ध्वं चाधो द्विधाऽपि वा।
 धर्मव्यायामशोकाध्वव्यवायैरतिसेवितैः।
 तीक्ष्णोष्णक्षारलवणैरम्लैः कटुभिरेव च॥1॥

Su.Ut. - 45/3-5

पित्तं विदग्धं स्वगुणैर्विदहत्याशु शोणितम्। Ma.Ni. - Raktapitta/1,2

- ❶ Excess intake of *Yava*¹ (barley), *Kola*² (*Ziziphus jujuba*), *Uddalaka*³ (a variety of rice), *Koradusha*⁴
- ❷ Excess intake of substances which are having strong potency and hot in quality⁵ such as chillies etc
- ❸ Excess intake of *Nishpava*,⁶ *Masha*,⁷ *Pinyaka*⁸, *Kulattha*,⁹ *Kshara*¹⁰
- ❹ Excess intake of *Dadhi*¹¹, *Dadhimanda*¹², *Udashvit*¹³, *Katvara*, *Amlakanjika*¹⁴
- ❺ Excess intake of flesh of *Varaha*, *Mahisha*, *Avika*, *Matsya* and *Go*
- ❻ Excess intake of *Pindalu*, *Shushka Shaka*
- ❼ Excess intake of *Mulaka*, *Sarshapa*, *Lashuna*, *Karanja*, *Shigru*, *Madhushigru*, *Sura*, *Souvira*, *Tushodaka*, *Maireya*, *Medaka*, *Madhulaka*, *Shukta*, *Kuvala*, *Badara* and *sour*

- 1 As per Charaka, the qualities of Yava are Ruksha (dry), Shita (cold in potency), Aguru (lightness), Madhura and Kashaya Rasa (sweet and astringent taste), responsible for Sthairya (stability), Balya (strength promoting), mitigation of Kapha dominant Vikara. Among above mentioned qualities of Yava, Laghu Guna is having the affinity towards the increase of Pitta Dosha in the body. Ref: Ca.Su. - 27/19-20
- 2 As per Bhava Prakasha Nighantu, Purvakhand, Mishra Prakarana, 7th chapter, Amradi Phala Varga, qualities of Kola are Grahi (constipating), Ruchya (tasty), Ushna (hot in potency), Vatala and Kapha Pittakara (responsible for the vitiation of all three Dosha), Guru (heavy to digest) and helpful in mitigating Atisara (diarrhoea). Whereas in Charaka Samhita, the qualities of Kola are mentioned in context of Badara i.e. Madhura (sweet in taste), Snigdha (unctuousness), Bhedana (facilitating the movement of Purisha in the formed and unformed form without eliminating the water portion from the large intestine), Vatapittahara (mitigating Vata and Pitta Dosha. In this context, Raktapitta may get manifested due to the increase of Snigdha Guna, Ushna Virya (hot potency) in the body.
- 3 As per Charaka, Uddalaka is a variety of Shashika Shali. The qualities are Sheeta (cold potency), Snigdha, (unctuousness) Aguru (lightness) Svadu (sweet taste), Tridosahara (mitigation of all Tridosha), Sthira (stability). In this occasion, there may be the possibility of increase of Pitta because of the increase of Snigdha and Laghu Guna in the body.
- 4 Koradusha is a variety of Shamidhanya, it has the qualities of Laghu (lightness), Vatala (Vata increasing), Kapha Pittahara (mitigating Kapha and Pitta), Shita (cold potency), Sangrahi (constipating by reducing water content) and Shoshana (dryness). The consumption of substances prepared out of Koradusha may produce Raktapitta by the increase of Laghu (lightness) quality.
- 5 This term refers to the consumption of substances having Ushna Virya. Most of the Ushna Virya substances will have impact on deeply situated tissues from Rasa Dhatu to Shukra Dhatu
- 6 As per Charaka in Ca.Su. - 27/33, Nishpava is having the qualities of vitiating of Vata and Pitta Dosha. Excess consumption will lead to the vitiation of either Pitta or Vata Dosha.
- 7 As per Charaka in Ca.Su. - 27/24, the qualities of Masha (black gram) are Vrishya (aphrodisiac), Vatahara (alleviating Vata Dosha), Snigdha (unctuousness), Ushna (hot in potency), Madhura (sweet in taste), Guru (heavy to digest), Balya (strength promoting), Bahumalakara. Pitta Dosha will get vitiated in the patient of Raktapitta due to the increase of Snigdha and Ushna qualities.
- 8 This refers to the remnants of sesamum seeds or mustard seeds after removal of oil in them by keeping these seeds in machine to extract oil.
- 9 Kulattha (horse gram) is considered to be definitely responsible for the manifestation of Amlapitta. Amlapitta is a Pitta dominant disease and Raktapitta is also considered to be the manifestation of Pitta dominance. Depending upon the site of the involvement of the Dosha Dushya Sammurchana in Rakta Dhatu, the person may develop Raktapitta.
- 10 As per Sushruta in Su.Su. - 11/5, Kshara is having following qualities and actions such as Ushna (hot in potency), Tikshna (highly irritating to the tissues), Pachana (Ama Pachana or Vrana Pachana), Shodhana (purification), Lekhana (removes the accumulation present inside the tubular structure or cells), Shoshana (dryness), Dahana (cauterisation) and Tridosahara (reduces all three Dosha if properly administered). Excess exposure to Kshara may lead to vitiation of Pitta Dosha and may vitiate Rakta Dhatu leading to the manifestation of Raktapitta.
- 11 As per Charaka, in Ca.Su. - 27/227, Dadhi is the causative factor for the manifestation of Raktapitta. As per Sushruta, in Su.Su. 45/66, consumption of Amla Dadhi (curds with sour taste) is responsible for the vitiation of Kapha and Pitta and Atyamla Dadhi (curds with extreme sour taste) will lead to the increase of impurities in the Rakta.
- 12 As per Charaka, in Ca.Su. - 27/228, consumption of Dadhimanda (upper fluid portion of curds) is said to be responsible for the alleviation of Vata and Kapha. It indirectly says there will be vitiation of Pitta during the course of the illness.
- 13 As per Dalhana, in his commentary on Su.Su. - 45/85, सस्नेहं सजलमुदश्चित्॥, the unctuous portion mixed with water during the preparation of Takra from Dadhi is termed as Udashvit. In Udashvit, we are not going to remove the unctuous portion. Udashvit is having the similar qualities of Dadhi.
- 14 धान्याम्लं काञ्जिकं शालिजूर्णाह्वकोद्रवादिकृतं मद्यम्॥ As per Dalhana in Su.Su. - 45/216, Kanjika is the preparation prepared by rice, Jurnahva (*Andropogon bicolor*, a plant), Kodrava (*Paspalum scrobiculatum*, a species of grain, also termed as kodo millet) etc. This is a type of alcoholic beverage.

taste substances¹⁵

- ✱ Excess consumption of substances prepared from flour or the flour substances which are heated or consumption of these substances along with milk or unboiled milk¹⁶
- ✱ Consumption of Rohinika or Kanakapota along with milk¹⁷
- ✱ Consumption of Kulattha, Pinyaka, Jambu, Pakva Lakucha phala or Shouktika fried in Sarshapa Taila or Kshara¹⁸
- ✱ Consumption of milk along with Ushnakara Dravya¹⁹
- ✱ Excess Atapa Sevana²⁰ (exposure to sunlight, after the consumption of Ushna, Tikshna, Vidahi and Viruddha Ahara in particular)
- ✱ Person who is doing Upavasa (fasting) or Vyayama (exercise) or Vyavaya (intercourse²¹)
- ✱ Krodha²²
- ✱ Shoka
- ✱ Bhaya

Samprapti of Raktapitta

क्षीरं पिवेत्युष्णाभितप्तः तस्यैवमाचरतः पित्तं प्रकोपमापद्यते, लोहितं

च स्वप्रमाणमतिवर्तते।

तस्मिन् प्रमाणातिवृत्ते पित्तं प्रकुपितं शरीरमनुसर्पद्यदेव यकृत्लीह-
प्रभवाणां लोहितवहानां च स्रोतसां लोहिताभिष्यन्दगुरुणि मुखान्यासाद्य
प्रतिरुन्ध्या तदेव लोहितं दूषयति॥4॥

Ca.Ni. – 2/4

- ✱ Due to various Pitta vitiating factors, Pitta will be in Prakopa stage.
- ✱ Vitiated Pitta Dosha will move all over the body and reach Mula (origin) of Raktavaha Srotas i.e. Yakrit and Pliha. Yakrit and Pliha are Srotomula of Raktavaha Srotas as per Charaka and Sushruta added Raktavahi Dhamani too along with Yakrit and Pliha.
- ✱ This will lead to Dushti of Rakta by abnormally vitiated Pitta having Abhishyandi and Guru qualities.
- ✱ This will lead to the manifestation of Raktapitta.

नित्यमभ्यसतो दुष्टो रसः पित्तं प्रकोपयेत्।

विदग्धं स्वगुणैः पित्तं विदहत्याशु शोणितम्॥4॥

ततः प्रवर्तते रक्तमूर्ध्वं चाधो द्विधाऽपि वा।

आमाशयाद्रजेदूर्ध्वमधः पकाशयाद्रजेत्॥5॥

विदग्धयोर्द्वयोश्चापि द्विधाभागं प्रवर्तते।

केचित् सयकृतः प्लीहः प्रवदन्त्यसृजो गतिम्॥6॥

Su.Ut. – 45/4-6

- ✱ Due to the various Pitta vitiating factors, Pitta will aggressively increase in its own site i.e. Amashaya²³

- 15 By nature, above said substances will have Amla Rasa, Laghu Guna and Amla Vipaka. When an individual consumes these substances, they are responsible for the vitiation of Pitta and in due course of time, vitiated Pitta will lead to the affliction of Rakta.
- 16 As per Sushruta, in Su.Su. – 45/61, Ama Kshira (unboiled milk) has the qualities of Abhishyanda (causing obstruction to the channels) and Guru (heavy to digest). Both the qualities are responsible for Srotorodha.
- 17 As per Charaka, in Ca.Su. – 25/84, the above said preparation if consumed in excess will lead to the conditions of Shonitabhishyanda and Dhamani Praticaya. This will lead to the affliction of Rakta Dhatu and the person will have vitiation of Pitta, thereby the person may have bleeding tendency.
- 18 The above said substances are having Ushna Virya. We know from earlier descriptions, the Ushna Virya substances will have affliction not only in Koshtha (alimentary canal), it also afflicts deeper tissues too. Excess consumption of Ushna Virya substances will increase the Tejo Mahabhuta in the body.
- 19 The consumption of milk along with Ushnavirya Dravya such as orange or sweet lime etc will be considered to be Viruddha (incompatible) in nature. Milk is having Madhura taste with Shita Virya where as orange or sweet lime will have Amla taste with Ushnavirya. Both in terms of Rasa, Guna and Virya, above mentioned Dravya are considered to be Viruddha (incompatible). This will vitiate Rakta in due course of time.
- 20 There are two mechanisms where the body can react to the hot environment – with or without acclimatisation. When a person is exposed to heat several hours each day while performing a reasonably heavy workload will develop increased tolerance to heat and humid conditions in 1 to 3 weeks. This is called heat acclimatisation. If an individual is exposed to hot environment for several hours at a time will have impact on the body without acclimatisation.
 - When an individual has acclimatisation to heat, there will two fold increase in maximum rate of sweating, an increase in plasma volume and diminished loss of salt in sweat and urine due to aldosterone secretion from adrenal glands.
 - When an individual is not acclimatised to heat, there will be
 - Vasodilatation of skin blood vessels in almost all areas of the body. These vessels are intensely dilated.
 - Profuse sweating across the skin
 - Reduced heat generation from the body
- 21 When there is increase in plasma volume and more amount of sweating taking place, there will be the increase in viscosity of blood which results in rupture of capillaries where there will be appearance of bleeding in different parts of the body as already vaso dilatation of the capillaries during the course of the disease. The nature of bleeding may be petechiae, ecchymosis and haematoma.
- 22 When an individual is doing Upavasa, there may be the vitiation of Pitta Dosha in the early phase of Upavasa. This can be evident after observing the increasing appetite at the time of performing Upavasa (fasting). Excess exercise and excessive sexual intercourse will have increased metabolic changes observed in the body. This can lead to increased production of heat. But metabolic changes observed in the body. When metabolic changes happen in the body. This indicates the increase of Pitta in the body.
- 23 There is a possibility of decreased dissipation of heat from the body. This activation may lead to the increased basal metabolic rate occurs in the body, that may lead to increased production of heat. But metabolic changes observed in the body. When metabolic changes happen in the body. This indicates the increase of Pitta in the body.
- 24 The above said emotional changes may lead to the activation of sympathetic nervous system in the body. This activation may lead to the increased heart rate, increased basal metabolic rate, increased pulse rate etc in the body. This may be an indication of increase of Pitta in the body.
- 25 Most of the diseases in Ayurveda are considered to be occurring due to the vitiation of Dosha where accumulation which is earliest stage

and tend to afflict *Rakta* because of *Ashraya Ashrayi* relation as the vitiated *Pitta* moves to the *Shakha*.

- Due to excess vitiation of *Pitta* and *Rakta Dhatu*, there will be bleeding through upper or lower routes or in both routes. If there is *Dushta Rakta* in *Amashaya*, the person will be presented with bleeding through upper routes and if the person is having *Dushta Rakta* in *Pakvashaya*, then there will be bleeding through lower routes. *Vidagdhavastha* of *Raktapitta* will be responsible for the bleeding through upper and lower routes.

पित्तं विदग्धं स्वगुणैर्विदहत्याशु शोणितम्।

ततः प्रवर्तते रक्तमूर्ध्वं चाधो द्विधाऽपि वा॥2॥

ऊर्ध्वं नासाक्षिकर्णास्यैर्मैत्रयोनिगुदैरधः।

कुपितं रोमकूपैश्च समस्तैस्तत्प्रवर्तते॥3॥

Ma.Ni. – 9th ch, *Raktapitta Nidana*/2,3

- Pitta* gets vitiated due to specific aetiological factors, which in turn leads to the vitiation of *Rakta Dhatu* in the body
- Abnormally vitiated *Rakta Dhatu*²⁴ will move in upward and downward direction.
- When there is upward movement of abnormally vitiated *Rakta*, bleeding occurs through nose, eyes, ears, oral cavity.
- When there is downward movement of abnormally vitiated *Rakta*, bleeding occurs through urethra, vagina and anus.
- When there is movement of abnormally vitiated *Rakta* in different directions, bleeding occurs through all above routes and roots of hairs.

Samprapti Ghataka

- Dosha : Pitta**

of Dosha vitiation occurs in the *Koshtha* (alimentary canal) in this particular occasion, it is *Amashaya*.

When an individual is suffering from the disease of alimentary canal, digestion, absorption and assimilation will be disturbed. Digestion of carbohydrate, fat and protein will be disturbed. When there is fat indigestion, the person will likely to have vitamin K deficiency. Vitamin K will be synthesised by colonic bacteria. Due to fat indigestion, the person will be having disturbances in the absorption of vitamin K too. Vitamin K is necessary for the formation of prothrombin, factor VII (proconvertin), factor IX and factor X, all of which are important for coagulation.

Thus, due to the imbalance in the digestion and metabolism, the person will suffer from bleeding disorders.

- 24 Bleeding diatheses are a group of disorders characterised by defective haemostasis with abnormal bleeding. The tendency to bleeding may be spontaneous in the form of small haemorrhages in the skin and mucosa (e.g. purpura, ecchymoses) or there may be excessive external or internal bleeding following trivial trauma and surgical procedure (e.g. haematoma, haemarthrosis). The bleeding can occur due to

- Haemorrhagic diathesis due to vascular abnormalities
- Haemorrhagic diathesis due to platelet abnormalities
- Haemorrhagic diathesis due to disorders of coagulation factors
- Combination of all these as in Disseminated Intravascular Coagulation (DIC)

- 25 Probable explanation in western medicine is difficult to get to understand the pathophysiology of *Raktapitta*. As per fundamentals of Ayurveda, *Raktapitta* is a *Pitta* dominant disease involves *Rakta* in due course of time. This is considered as *Sharirika Vikara* among *Doshabala Pravritta Vikara* of *Adhyatmika Vikara*.

As the disease is considered to be *Sharirika* (physical) in nature, its early manifestation starts from *Koshtha* (alimentary canal) and progresses to different parts of the body. Hence, most of the *Lakshana* produced during the progression of the disease, are usually related to *Koshtha* or *Mahasrotas* only. Depending upon the site of the bleeding, the prodromal symptoms are observed. Suppose for example, if the person is supposed to be suffering from *Urdhvaga Raktapitta*, he may show the prodromal symptoms pertaining to upper alimentary canal.

- Dushya: Rakta*
- Srotas: Raktavaha Srotas*
- Srotodushti Prakara: Sanga and Vimargagamana*
- Agni: Jatharagni, Raktadhatvagni*
- Ama: Jatharagnijanya, Raktadhatvagnijanya*
- Udbhava Sthana: Amashaya*
- Sanchara Sthana: Sarva Sharira*
- Vyakta Sthana: Nasa, Akshi, Asya, Karna, Mutramarga, Yoni, Guda, Romakupa*
- Rogamarga: Abhyantara, Bahya*
- Vyadhi Svabhava: Ashukari*
- Sadhyasadyata: Krichrasadhyata to Asadhyata*

Purvarupa of Raktapitta

The *Purvarupa* observed when the person could be suffering from *Raktapitta*²⁵ are as follow:

तस्येमानि पूर्वरूपाणि भवन्ति तद्यथा - अनन्ना भिलाषः, भुक्तस्य विदाहः, शुक्ताम्लगन्धरस उद्गारः, छर्देर भीक्षणमागमनं छर्दितस्य बीभत्सता, स्वर- भेदो, गात्राणां सदनं, परिदाहः, मुखाद्भूमागम इव, लोहलोहितमत्स्यामगन्धित्वमिव चास्यस्य, रक्त- रितहारिद्रत्वमद्गावयवशक्नुमूत्र स्वेदलाला सिङ्घाण- कास्यकर्णं मल पिडकोलिकापिडकानाम्, अङ्गवेदना, लोहितनीलपीतश्यावानामर्चिष्यतां च रूपाणां स्वप्ने दर्शनमभीक्ष्णमिति (लोहितपित्तपूर्वरूपाणि भवन्ति)॥6॥

Ca.Ni. – 2/6

सदनं शीतकामित्वं कण्ठधूमायनं वमिः॥7॥

लोहगन्धिश्च निःश्वासो भवत्यस्मिन् भविष्यति।

Su.Ut. – 45/7,8

- Aversion to take food
- If at all, a person takes food, then there will be burning sensation during the digestion of food, sour eructation due to *Shuktabhava* of ingested food.

- Severe projectile vomiting associated with hoarseness of voice
- Sluggish movement of body parts
- Burning sensation all over the body
- Person will have sensation similar to the sensation as if smoke comes through mouth
- Person will have smell similar to metal, blood, fish or raw meat through the mouth
- Reddish, greenish, yellowish discolouration of the body parts, faecal matter, urine, sweat, salivary secretion, nasal mucosa, ears, secretion of eyes
- Severe pain all over the body in the areas of skin eruptions
- Patient will have dreams like fire is red, blue and dark.
- As per *Sushruta*,
- Sluggish movements all over the body
- Liking towards cold substances
- Burning sensation in the throat region
- Vomiting
- The breath of the individual will have smell of metal

Types of Raktapitta

Based on *Dosha* dominance

सान्द्रं पाण्डु सस्नेहं पिच्छिलं च कफान्वितम्।
श्यावारुणं सफेनं च तनु रूक्षं च वातिकम्॥ 1 ॥
रक्तपित्तं कषायाभं कृष्णं गोमूत्रसंनिभम्।
मेचकागारधूमाभमञ्जनाभं च पैत्तिकम्॥ 2 ॥

संसृष्टलिङ्गं संसर्गात्रिलिङ्गं सान्निपातिकम्।

Ca.Ci. - 4/11-13

7 types based on Dosha dominance

Vataja, *Pittaja*, *Kaphaja*, *Sannipataja*, *Dvandvaja* – 3 types

- **Vataja Raktapitta:** blackish discolouration of *Rakta*, foams will come along with blood discharge, thin blood and dryness of the blood can be seen
- *Pittaja Raktapitta:*
- *Kaphaja Raktapitta*
- Mixed features are seen in *Raktapitta* having mixed *Dosha* vitiation
- *Sannipataja Lakshana* are seen in the patients having *Sannipata Dosha* vitiation

Upadrava of Raktapitta

उपद्रवास्तु खलु दौर्बल्यारोचकाविपाकश्यासकासज्वरातीसारशोफ-
शोषपाण्डुरोगाः खरमेदधः॥ 7 ॥

Ca.Ni. - 2/7

दौर्बल्यश्वासकासज्वरवमथुमदाः पाण्डुतादाहमूर्च्छा भुते चात्रे
विदाहस्त्वधृतिरपि सदा हृद्यतुल्या च पीडा।

तृष्णा कण्ठस्य भेदः शिरसि च दवनं पूतिनिष्ठीवनं च द्वेषो भक्तेऽविपाको
विरतिरपि रते रक्तपित्तोपसर्गाः॥ 9 ॥

Su.Ut. 45/9

- Weakness²⁶
- Tastelessness
- Indigestion²⁷
- Breathing discomfort¹⁸
- Cough²⁸

26 This can be observed as a consequence of either non progressive or progressive haemorrhagic shock. Non progressive haemorrhagic shock (compensated shock) is a reversible type of haemorrhagic shock. The following factors are responsible for the reversibility of shock.

1. Baroreceptors reflexes which elicit powerful sympathetic stimulation of the circulation
2. Central nervous system ischemic response, elicits even more powerful sympathetic stimulation throughout the body, but is not activated significantly until the arterial pressure falls below 50 mmHg.
3. Reverse stress relaxation of the circulator system, which causes the blood vessels to contract around the diminished blood volume, so that the blood volume that is available for more adequately fills the circulation.
4. Formation of angiotensin by kidneys which constricts peripheral arteries and causes decreased output of water and salt by the kidneys
5. Formation of vasopressin (ADH) by neurohypophysis which constricts peripheral arteries and veins and greatly water retention by the kidneys.
6. Compensatory mechanisms that return the blood volume back to normal, including absorption of large quantities of fluid into the blood capillaries from interstitial compartment, conservation of salt and water by the kidneys and increased thirst and increased appetite for salt.

Sympathetic reflexes maximally activated within 30 seconds to minute after haemorrhage.

Progressive shock: This type of haemorrhagic shock will have

1. Cardiac depression leading reduced cardiac output
2. Vasomotor failure i.e. depression of brain usually occurs if the arterial pressure falls below 30 mmHg
3. Blockage of very small vessels (microvessels or capillaries) leading to slowness of circulation
4. Increased capillary permeability occurs as a sequel of blockage of capillaries.
5. Release of toxins from ischemic tissue such as histamine, serotonin etc.

27 Tastelessness and indigestion can occur due to severe form of hypovolemic shock. In this situation, there will be shift of blood supply from alimentary canal to the heart and brain. Due to the poor blood supply to the alimentary canal, the individual may also suffer from thirst and aversion to take food.

28 This can be attributable to the bleeding occurring in the respiratory system. Here, the person may have cough with haemoptysis and expiratory breathlessness. If the bleeding occurring in the upper respiratory system or around the gums and if it enters the larynx and other

- ⊗ Raised body temperature²⁹
- ⊗ Diarrhoea³⁰
- ⊗ Swelling³¹
- ⊗ Emaciation of the body³²
- ⊗ Pandu (anemia)³³
- ⊗ Hoarseness of voice
- ⊗ Vomiting
- ⊗ Burning sensation³⁴
- ⊗ Altered state of consciousness³⁵
- ⊗ Discomfort in the chest³⁶
- ⊗ Thirst³⁷
- ⊗ Headache³⁸
- ⊗ Sputum mixed with pus or Puya
- ⊗ Aversion to take food
- ⊗ Restlessness

Sadhyasadhyata of Raktapitta

ऊर्ध्वं साध्यमधोयाप्यमसाध्यं युगपद्गतम्।

Su.Ut. 45/7

- ⊗ Urdhvaga Raktapitta is Sadhya (easily curable)
- ⊗ Adhoga Raktapitta is Yasya (manageable)
- ⊗ Ubhayagata Raktapitta is Asadhyata (incurable)

Asadhyata Lakshana of Raktapitta

मांसप्रक्षालनाभं कथितमिव च यत् कर्दमाम्भोनिभं वा मेदः पूयास्त्रकलं
यकृदिव यदि वा पक्कजम्बूफलाभम्।
यत् कृष्णं यच्च नीलं भृशमतिकुणपं यत्र चोक्ता विकारास्तद्वयं रक्तपित्तं
सुरपतिधनुषा यच्च तुल्यं विभाति॥१०॥

Su.Ut. - 45/10

- ⊗ Blood resembles the colour of water after meat wash³⁹
- ⊗ Blood resembles the colour of rotten food⁴⁰
- ⊗ Blood resembles the colour of Kardama (mud)⁴¹
- ⊗ Blood mixed with Meda (fat tissue), Puya (pus) or resembling the colour of Pakoa Jambhu Phala (dark purple colour)
- ⊗ Dark blood or bluish coloured blood⁴² or smell of dead body comes in the patient of Raktapitta⁴³

G
K

- structures distal to larynx, he may have hoarseness of voice.
- 29 This complication can be attributable to thrombocytopenia. When an individual is suffering from chronic haemorrhage, the person will have activation of production of pluripotent haemopoietic stem cells. Depending upon the requirement of the body, the person may have increased production of RBC, WBC and platelets. Everyday, human body is exposed to millions of microorganisms. Due to the antigen antibody reaction, the person may have raised body temperature.
- 30 When an individual is presented with diarrhoea, that will lead to disturbed absorption of nutrients, macro as well as micronutrients. In the individuals having bleeding diatheses, and if he is suffering from diarrhoea, that will lead to the decreased absorption of vitamin K which is one of the essential ingredient required for the formation of coagulation factors.
- 31 This can be attributable to swelling due to accumulation of blood in a particular part of the body such as haemarthrosis or haematoma etc.
- 32 This occurs as a result of hypoxia which results as a result of anemia which is a sequel of haemorrhage. Due to haemorrhage, there will be hypovolemia which is leading to anemia. Low haemoglobin is the after effect of the anemia and the final result is poor blood flow to the periphery. Due to this, there will be loss of adipose tissue from the subcutaneous tissue and other areas of the body which will lead to emaciation of the body.
- 33 This occurs as a consequence of uncontrolled bleeding in the diseased individual. After rapid haemorrhage, the body replaces the fluid portion of the plasma in 1 to 3 days. If a secondary haemorrhage does not occur, the red blood cell concentration returns to normal within 3 to 6 weeks.
- In case of chronic blood loss, a person frequently cannot absorb enough iron from the intestine to form haemoglobin as rapidly as it is lost.
- 34 This may be observed in the patients of chronic and active gastric ulcer wherein there will be thinning of the gastric mucosa and the person may have burning sensation due to slight secretion of hydrochloric acid from the oxyntic cells of the stomach.
- 35 This is attributable to the progression of the hypovolemic shock which results in syncopal attack or it may occur as a result of haemorrhage inside the brain.
- 36 This is attributable to the progression of the hypovolemic shock which results in syncopal attack or it may occur as a result of haemorrhage inside the brain.
- 37 This may be observed in a state of dehydration which occurs as a result of acute blood loss.
- 38 The presence of headache can be attributable to haemorrhage occurring inside the head. This is usually progressive in nature and is associated with projectile vomiting due to the increased intracranial pressure.
- 39 It refers to dark black or brown colour. This is specifically seen in haemorrhage in the upper alimentary canal. It happens due to the formation of acid haematin as the blood mixes with the hydrochloric acid secreted in the stomach. This leads to the transformation of blood into dark brown coloured acid haematin. This colour resembles the colour of water after meat wash.
- 40 In this, the term rotten food indicates the blood having the colour of rotten food, i.e. the ingested food will have fading or darkening colour. While analysing the blood during bleeding, the blood from the venous part of cardiovascular system will have darker discolouration. In other words, the bleeding from the venous part of cardiovascular system may be considered in case of abnormal discolouration.
- 41 This represents the necrosis of the affected part where bleeding is occurring.
- 42 Among the cardiovascular system, out of 100%, 64% of the blood remains in veins. In other words, if one observes dark coloured blood, it probably indicates the bleeding from the veins. More amount of blood loss can occur if proper measures are not taken to check the blood loss.
- 43 This is attributable to the release of hydrogen sulphide gas from the wound or area of bleed.

Key summary of the chapter

- Raktapitta is a spectrum of diseases where there is Pitta Dosha dominance is observed throughout the progression of the disease. In this disease, there is possibility of bleeding through natural orifices or through skin. Depending upon the site of bleeding, association of Dosha vitiation along with Pitta Dosha may vary. For example, if the person is presenting with bleeding through nose, there is a possibility of association of Kapha Dosha along with Pitta and in case of Vata Dosha association, the individual may have bleeding tendency through anus or urethra or vagina. Ca.Ci. – 4/9
- Abnormal vitiation of Pitta due to various Pitta vitiating reasons will combine together with abnormal Rakta in the body leading to the manifestation of Raktapitta.
- Raktapitta is a Amashayasamuttha Vikara with the involvement of Raktavaha Srotas with Yakrit and Pliha as the probable Srotomula afflicted during the genesis and progression of the disease with Sanga and Vimargagamana as the type of Srotodushti afflicted.
- As far as the types of Raktapitta, two different types of Raktapitta are mentioned based on the appearance of blood in different routes of the body and based on the dominance of Dosha in the body, Urdhvaga, Adhoga and Ubhayaga Raktapitta are the 3 types based on the appearance of bleeding in the human body. Based on the type of Dosha dominance, 7 types of Raktapitta are mentioned: Vataja, Pittaja, Kaphaja, Vatapittaja, Pittakaphaja, Vatakaphaja and Sannipataja Raktapitta.
- Most of the Nidana (etiological factors) responsible for the manifestation of Raktapitta are considered to be having Ushna and Tikshna Guna or Tejo Mahabhuta dominance.

Self-Assessment: Questions for Reviews

Long essay questions

- Define Raktapitta. Explain Nidana, Purvarupa, Bheda, Lakshana, Asadhya Lakshana and Sadhyasadyata of Raktapitta

Short essay questions

- Describe Urdhvaga Raktapitta
- Explain Adhoga Raktapitta
- Explain the types of Raktapitta
- Describe Sadhyasadyata of Raktapitta

MCQs

1. Dosha dominance observed in the patient of Raktapitta in general is

- a. Vata;
- b. Pitta;
- c. Kapha;
- d. All of the above

Answer: (b)

2. Udbhava Sthana of Raktapitta is

- a. Amashayasamuttha;
- b. Pakvashayasamuttha;
- c. Both Amashayasamuttha and Pakvashayasamuttha;
- d. Neither Amashayasamuttha nor Pakvashayasamuttha

Answer: (a)

3. The type of Srotodushti observed in the lady who is having excessive menstruation is

- a. Atipravritti;
- b. Sanga and Vimargagamana;
- c. Vimargagamana;

- d. Apravritti

Answer: (a)

4. The type of Srotodushti observed in the patient who is suffering from nasal bleeding is

- a. Atipravritti;
- b. Sanga and Vimargagamana;
- c. Vimargagamana;
- d. Apravritti

Answer: (b)

5. Anubandha Dosha observed in the patient suffering from Urdhvaga Raktapitta is

- a. Vata;
- b. Kapha;
- c. Vata and Kapha;
- d. None of the above

Answer: (b)

6. Anubandhya Dosha in the Raktapitta diseased individual observed will be

- a. Vata;
- b. Kapha;
- c. Vata and Kapha;
- d. Pitta

Answer: (d)

7. Which of the following disease pattern is having Atipravritti pattern in the context of Raktapitta?

- a. Prameha;
- b. Atisara;
- c. Raktapradara;

- d. Bleeding through nose

Answer: (c)

8. If we consider the blood of cardiovascular system as 100%, the percentage of blood present in the veins of the human body is

- a. 30%; b. 50%;
c. 64%; d. 80%

Answer: (c)

9. Primary Srotas afflicted in the patient of Raktapitta is

- a. Rasavaha Srotas;
b. Raktavaha Srotas;
c. Majjavaha Srotas;
d. Purishavaha Srotas

Answer: (b)

10. Sankhya Samprapti of Raktapitta based on the Dosha dominance is

- a. 4 types; b. 2 types;
c. 7 types; d. 12 types

Answer: (c)

11. Loha Gandhi Shvasa (metallic odour) during inspiration is the Purvarupa observed in

- a. Pandu; b. Kamala;
c. Raktapitta; d. Amlapitta

Answer: (c)

12. Which coagulation factor is involved in haemophilia?

- a. Factor IV; b. Factor VIII;
c. Factor IX; d. Factor X

Answer: (b)

13. In the pathogenesis of Raktapitta, which of the following character of Pitta Dosha will be abnormally increased?

- a. Ushna; b. Drava;
c. Sara; d. Snigdha

Answer: (b)

14. Which of the following diseases are considered as Yapyas except

- a. Tamaka Shvasa;

- b. Pittaja Prameha;
c. Urdhvaga Raktapitta;
d. Adhoga Raktapitta

Answer: (c)

15. Urdhvaga Raktapitta is

- a. Yapyas; b. Anupakrama;
c. Sadhya; d. Asadhya

Answer: (c)

Chapter resources

- <https://www.coagadex.com/rare-bleeding-disorders>
- Charaka Samhita Nidana Sthana 2nd chapter Raktapitta Nidana Adhyaya
- Charaka Samhita Chikitsa Sthana 4th chapter Raktapitta Chikitsa Adhyaya
- Sushruta Samhita Uttara Tantra 45th chapter - Raktapitta Pratishedha Adhyaya
- Madhava Nidana 9th chapter - Raktapitta Nidana Adhyaya
- Golwalla's medicine for students by Aspi F Golwalla and Sharukh A Golwalla, edited by Milind Y Nadkar, 25th edition, Jaypee Brothers Medical Publishers (P) Ltd, New Delhi, 2017
- The Merck Manual of Diagnosis and Therapy by Robert S Porter and Justin L Kaplan, 19th edition, Merck Sharp & Dohme Corp, New Jersey, 2011
- Chamberlain's symptoms and signs in clinical medicine by Colin Ogilvie and Christopher C Evans, 12th edition, Butterworth-Heinemann Publishers, 1997
- Best & Taylor's physiological basis of medical practice by O P Tandon and Y Tripathi, 13th edition, Wolters Kluwer Health (India) Pvt. Ltd, Gurgaon, 2012
- Textbook of Medical physiology by Arthur C Guyton and John E Hall, 11th edition, Saunders Elsevier publications, Philadelphia, 2006
